people did not hide their anger. It exposed the real agenda and dichotomy of the jehadis. Soon we opened the Poonch-Rawalakot road and further enhanced the people-to-people contacts.

However, we have been unable to optimally utilize the capability of the media to brand Pakistan as the aggressor for all the wars fought over Kashmir. The people of Kashmir on both sides of the LoC have been misled by the Pakistani media and their propaganda machinery. It was quite surprising to note that people from PoK, travelling by bus from Muzaffarabad to Srinagar, asked if they could do the namaz when they crossed over to the Indian side. Such is the scale of disinformation that the people are being subjected to. They are quite astonished to see the development on the Indian side as compared to PoK. Perhaps it is for this reason that when the people of PoK wanted to cross the LoC en masse in the 1990s, it was the Pakistan Army that placed roadblocks on the road from Muzaffarabad to Baramulla.

There is no apparent change in Pakistan's intent to provide the terrorists moral, diplomatic and financial help. Occasional restrictions placed on terrorist groups remain calibrated, cosmetic and reversible. Pakistani senior officers often brag in typical Punjabi that the 'tooti' (tap) is in their hands. The infrastructure of the terrorist organizations remains intact in PoK and in Pakistan as well. General (Retd) Mirza Aslam Beg's improvident idea that with the nuclear deterrent, 'he could convert the Kashmir intafada into an armed insurgency,'[4] is revelatory. Besides that, Ayesha Siddiqa has recounted being told by General Pervez Musharraf, 'What makes you think that once Kashmir is over, there will be an end to the conflict with India. That's what drove his thinking and that's what drives the thinking of most of our generals.'[5] It would serve us well if our policy-planners keep these statements in mind. The threats to our security, I dare say, would continue in the years to come, and even beyond Kashmir! The recent terror attacks in Bombay and Delhi portend the challenges that lie ahead for us.

Having said that, the overall situation in J&K is improving gradually. The visit by Prime Minister Manmohan Singh on 7 June 2010, the formation of a body of interlocuters and various other